



SHAILESH RAVAL

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# CREATIVE ADVANTAGE

In 1951, when the then prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru invited celebrated American designers Charles and Ray Eames to study the industrial design scene in India and suggest solutions for its improvement, few could foresee that it would rank among the top 30 design institutes of the world (*Business Week*, 2007). Set up in 1961, the National Institute of Design (NID) started imparting formal education in 1970. Since then, it has come a long way and can boast of a highly decorated alumni list. The latest among them are Titan's Michael Foley and *Taare Zameen Par* animator Dhimant Vyas.

Attached with 25 global institutes that include the Royal College of Art,

London, and Sheridan College, Canada, for student and faculty exchange programmes, NID is now going through an orbit shift from a skill-based institute to a concept-based university. Known for its hands-on and minds-on approach, NID's greatest contribution is a new movement for design awareness through education, consultancy and advocacy which has led to standardisation of good design products in India. Says Director Darlie O Koshy, "When NID was floated, design defined standards. It was in the realm of *roti, kapda aur makaan*. But today it defines quality of life, bringing in a lot of intangibles. Its experiential focus is now based on research."

by Uday Mahurkar

"New age design is breaking many boundaries. It's playing a key role in linking manufactured products and technology support to the user."

DARLIE O KOSHY, DIRECTOR, NID

## 35

The number of international institutes the National Institute of Design is associated with for student and faculty exchange programmes.